AIKO SCHMEISSER

aiko.schmeisser@gmail.com | aikoschmeisser.com

Last updated: November 2026

CURRENT POSITION

Rockwool Foundation Berlin — Since November 2026
Postdoctoral Researcher

RESEARCH FIELDS

Labor Economics, Political Economy, Behavioral Economics

AFFILIATIONS

Berlin School of Economics — Since November 2026
Research Associate

IZA@LISER — Since March 2026
Research Affiliate

PREVIOUS POSITIONS

Columbia University — 2025 - 2026
Postdoctoral Researcher at the Center for Political Economy

University of Potsdam — 2021 - 2025
Research Assistant at the Chair of Empirical Economics

EDUCATION

University of Potsdam & Berlin School of Economics — 2020 - 2025
Ph.D. in Economics, Summa cum laude
Supervisor: Marco Caliendo, Thomas Siedler
Title of dissertation: Political and Racial Dynamics in the Labor Market

Harvard University — January - May, 2024
Visiting research fellow at the Center for Labor and a Just Economy

University of Göttingen — 2018 - 2020
M.Sc. in International Economics

University of Bayreuth — 2014 - 2018
B.Sc. in Economics, B.A. in International Economics and Development

PUBLICATIONS AND ACCEPTED

Do Unions Shape Political Ideologies at Work? (with Johannes Matzat), 2026, ***American Economic Journal: Applied Economics***, Conditionally Accepted. [WP version]

The Accuracy of Job Seekers' Wage Expectations (with Marco Caliendo, Robert Mahlstedt, and Sophie Wagner), 2026, ***Journal of Public Economics***, 262, 105764, 1-10. [Published version] [WP version]

A Tale of (Almost) 1001 Coefficients: Deep and Heterogeneous Effects of the EU-Turkey Customs Union (with Mario Larch and Joschka Wanner), 2021, ***Journal of Common Market Studies***, 59(2), 242-260. [Published version]

WORKING PAPERS

Economic Shocks, Opportunity Costs, and the Supply of Politicians (with Laura Barros), CESifo Working Paper No. 12327. [link] *R&R American Economic Journal: Applied Economics.*

Perceptions of Race in the Labor Market (with Pedro C. Sant'Anna and Sulin Sardoschau), RFBerlin Discussion Paper No. 74/26. [link]

Racial Peer Effects at Work: Evidence from Worker Deaths in Brazil (with Katharina Fietz). World Bank Policy Research Working Paper No. 10899. [link]

WORK IN PROGRESS

Workplace Social Pressure and Union Collective Action (with Alex Hertel-Fernandez, Suresh Naidu, and Adam Reich).

Identity in Politics (with Pedro C. Sant'Anna and Sulin Sardoschau).

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Conference and Seminar Presentations

ASSA Annual Meeting (Washington, D.C.) 2027

Labor and Public Finance Colloquium (Columbia U), Society of Labor Economics (Denver), RFBerlin Workshop (Nizza Monferrato), Joint Rockwool Berlin-Kopenhagen Workshop (Berlin) 2026

Political Economy of Work Junior Scholars Workshop (Columbia U), European Economic Association (Bordeaux), CESifo Junior Workshop on Labor Economics (Munich), Workshop on the Economics of Identity (Berlin), Research Seminar in Economics (Potsdam) 2025

Verein für Socialpolitik (Berlin), IZA Summer School (Bonn), Society of Labor Economists (Portland), European Economic Association (Rotterdam), Economics PhD Conference (Warwick), RIDGE / LACEA Workshops on Labor & Political Economy (Santiago de Chile), European Society for Population Economics (Rotterdam), Midwest Political Science Association (Chicago), Political Economy Workshop (Harvard U), Rockwool Foundation Graduate Seminar (Berlin), BSoE Applied Micro & Behavioral Economics Workshop (Berlin), BeNA Winter Workshop (Berlin), Applied Young Economist Webinar (online) 2024

European Association of Labor Economics (Prague), European Economic Association (Barcelona), Society for Institutional & Organizational Economics (Frankfurt), European Society for Population Economics (Belgrade), IAAEU Colloquium on Economics (Trier), Research Seminar in Economics (Potsdam) 2023

ifo Workshop on Political Economy (Dresden), Verein für Socialpolitik (Basel), European Association of Labor Economics (Padua), European Society for Population Economics (Calabria), FU Research Seminar for Applied Micro (Berlin), BeNA Winter Workshop (Berlin), BSoE Summer Workshop (Berlin) 2022

European Association of Labor Economics (online), European Society for Population Economics (online) 2021

Services to the Profession

Referee for *Quarterly Journal of Economics, Labour Economics, Empirical Economics*

Board member and treasurer of the Berlin Network of Labor Market Research (BeNA) [link] 2024 -

SCHOLARSHIPS & AWARDS

Joachim Herz Add-on Fellowship for Interdisciplinary Economics and Interdisciplinary Business Administration, 12,500 Euro 2023 - 2025

DAAD Research Stay Grant for Doctoral Students, 4,600 Euro 2024

DAAD Conference Travel Grant, 1,000 Euro 2024

Wicksell Prize of the European Public Choice Society, 2nd place 2023
for the research paper "Do Unions Shape Political Ideologies at Work?"

Student scholarship Konrad Adenauer Foundation 2015 - 2018

TEACHING

University of Potsdam

Advanced Microeconometrics (practical session, graduate level)	Winter 2021/22, 2022/23, 2023/24
Policy Evaluation (practical session, graduate level)	Summer 2023
Research Idea Development Seminar (seminar, graduate level)	Winter 2021/22, 2023/24
Advanced Methods and Applications in Policy Evaluation (seminar, graduate level)	Winter 2022/23
Methods in Policy Evaluation (seminar, undergraduate level)	Summer 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025
Statistics (practical session, undergraduate level)	Summer 2022
Supervision of final theses (7× undergraduate and 4× graduate level)	Winter 2021/22 - Summer 2025

University of Bayreuth

Macroeconomics I (practical session, undergraduate level)	Summer 2016, 2017
Microeconomics I (practical session, undergraduate level)	Winter 2015/16

ADDITIONAL WORK EXPERIENCE

University of Göttingen 2018 - 2020
Student Research Assistant at the Research Training Group Globalization and Development
Fieldwork Assistant for RCT in Cambodia

German Council of Economic Experts 2018
Internship at Labor Market Team of Scientific Staff

University of Bayreuth 2017 - 2018
Student Research Assistant at Chair of Development Economics

German Ministry for Economic Affairs and Energy 2017
Internship at Department for Trade Policy with North America